炸药大王的救心药

Dynamite for the Heart



同一种液体，怎样既能炸山又能救心？

READ 纯净阅读

CHECK 中文核对

LEARN 词汇记忆

RECALL 回想巩固

英文原文

Around 1847 the Italian chemist Sobrero first made nitroglycerin, a colourless, oily liquid of acute instability. A mere droplet on the tongue, he reported, left his head throbbing violently for hours. On 3 September 1864 a nitroglycerin shed in Stockholm exploded. The tragic blast killed five, including Alfred Nobel's younger brother Emil.

Nobel tamed the liquid by blending it with kieselguhr, a porous earth, into a paste shaped into rods. Patented in 1867 as dynamite, it was harnessed for mining, quarrying, and demolition, enriching him immensely. His 1895 testament made the fortune an endowment for prizes, first awarded in 1901.

Nitroglycerin had side-effects. Factory operatives suffered racking headaches, and their tolerance, built over the week, ebbed at weekends. Mondays brought a recurrence, with dizziness and palpitations, hence the name Monday disease. In 1879 William Murrell reported in The Lancet on its therapeutic use against angina pectoris, attacks of chest pain.

On 25 October 1896 Nobel, who had angina, wrote to his aide that by an irony of fate doctors had prescribed him nitroglycerin to take internally. Its alias, Trinitrin, was chosen, he explained, to avoid frightening pharmacists or the public. He did not comply. Partly paralysed by a cerebral haemorrhage, he died at his San Remo villa on 10 December 1896.

In 1977 Murad ascertained that nitroglycerin releases nitric oxide, which widens blood vessels. Furchgott found an unidentified relaxing factor in vascular linings in 1980, and Ignarro recognised it as nitric oxide in 1986. The trio shared the 1998 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine. Its presentation speech, on 10 December, the anniversary of Nobel's death, quoted his ironic letter.

中文译文

1847年前后，意大利化学家索布雷罗首次制得硝酸甘油。这是一种无色、油状、极不稳定的液体。他报告说，仅在舌头上滴一小滴，就会使头部剧烈抽痛数小时。1864年9月3日，斯德哥尔摩一间存放硝酸甘油的棚屋爆炸，造成五人死亡，其中包括阿尔弗雷德·诺贝尔的弟弟埃米尔。

诺贝尔将这种液体与多孔的硅藻土混合，制成糊状物，再塑成棒状，使它变得更可控。这种炸药于1867年获得专利，用于采矿、采石和拆除工程，让他积累了巨额财富。他在1895年立下遗嘱，以这笔财产设立奖项基金，奖项于1901年首次颁发。

硝酸甘油也有副作用。工厂工人饱受剧烈头痛之苦；他们在一周工作中逐渐产生的耐受性，到周末又会减退。每到星期一，头痛便再次发作，还伴有眩晕和心悸，因此被称为“星期一病”。1879年，威廉·默雷尔在《柳叶刀》报告了硝酸甘油治疗心绞痛的用途。心绞痛就是阵发性的胸痛。

1896年10月25日，患有心绞痛的诺贝尔写信给助手，感叹命运的讽刺：医生竟开了硝酸甘油让他内服。他解释说，这种药另取名为Trinitrin，是为了不吓到药剂师或公众。他没有遵从医嘱。后来，他因脑出血而部分瘫痪，于1896年12月10日在圣雷莫的别墅中去世。

1977年，穆拉德查明，硝酸甘油会释放一氧化氮，使血管扩张。1980年，弗奇戈特在血管内壁发现了一种身份尚不明确的舒张因子；1986年，伊格纳罗认定它就是一氧化氮。三人共同获得1998年诺贝尔生理学或医学奖。12月10日颁奖时，致辞引用了诺贝尔那封感叹命运讽刺的信；那天也正是他的逝世纪念日。

未遵医嘱与死亡不应混作因果；文章明确交代诺贝尔脑出血。

核心词汇

先记这22项。连着下方的原文短语一起回想。

chemist n.
化学家
the Italian chemist Sobrero

nitroglycerin n.
硝酸甘油
first made nitroglycerin

acute adj.
极度的；严重的
of acute instability

instability n.
不稳定性
of acute instability

tame v.
使受控；驯服
Nobel tamed the liquid

blend v.
混合
blending it with kieselguhr

porous adj.
多孔的
a porous earth

harness v.
控制并利用
harnessed for mining

demolition n.
拆除工程
mining, quarrying, and demolition

enrich v.
使富有
enriching him immensely

testament n.
遗嘱
His 1895 testament

fortune n.
巨额财富
the fortune an endowment

endowment n.
捐赠基金
an endowment for prizes

tolerance n.
耐受性
their tolerance

recurrence n.
复发
a recurrence, with dizziness

therapeutic adj.
治疗的；有疗效的
its therapeutic use

prescribe v.
开具（药物）处方
doctors had prescribed him

comply v.
遵从
He did not comply

ascertain v.
查明
Murad ascertained

unidentified adj.
尚未确认身份的
an unidentified relaxing factor

vascular adj.
血管的
vascular linings

anniversary n.
周年纪念日
the anniversary of Nobel's death

文中词汇与搭配

补充词汇共42项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

Italian adj.
意大利的

colourless adj.
无色的

oily adj.
油状的

liquid n.
液体

mere adj.
仅仅的；不过是

droplet n.
小滴

throb v.
一阵阵抽痛

violently adv.
剧烈地

shed n.
棚屋

tragic adj.
悲惨的

paste n.
糊状物

rod n.
棒；条

mining n.
采矿

quarrying n.
采石

immensely adv.
极其

nitroglycerin n.
硝酸甘油

side effect n.
副作用

factory operative n.
工厂工人

racking adj.
剧烈折磨人的

ebb v.
减退

dizziness n.
眩晕

文中词汇与搭配 续

补充词汇共42项。保留每个表达在本文中的意思。

palpitation n.
心悸

hence adv.
因此

aide n.
助手

by an irony of fate 介词短语
命运弄人地

internally adv.
通过内服

alias n.
别名

frighten v.
使害怕

pharmacist n.
药剂师

partly adv.
部分地

paralyse v.
使瘫痪

cerebral haemorrhage n.
脑出血

villa n.
别墅

nitric oxide n.
一氧化氮

widen v.
使扩张

factor n.
因子

lining n.
内壁；内层

trio n.
三人组

Nobel Prize n.
诺贝尔奖

presentation n.
颁授；颁奖

quote v.
引用

ironic adj.
具有讽刺意味的

回想与回顾

先遮住下方答案，再把四个词放回原文。

01 Around 1847 the Italian chemist Sobrero first made nitroglycerin, a colourless, oily liquid of acute _____.

02 Factory operatives suffered racking headaches, and their _____, built over the week, ebbed at weekends.

03 He did not _____.

04 In 1977 Murad _____ that nitroglycerin releases nitric oxide, which widens blood vessels.

文章主线

- 危险 1847年前后，索布雷罗制得极不稳定的硝酸甘油；1864年的爆炸夺走五人生命，包括诺贝尔的弟弟。
- 炸药 诺贝尔将硝酸甘油与硅藻土混合制成炸药，1867年获专利，凭此致富，后来遗赠财产设立奖项。
- 药用 工人接触它会头痛，周末耐受下降、周一复发；1879年，默雷尔报告它能治疗心绞痛。
- 讽刺 诺贝尔晚年患心绞痛，也被开了硝酸甘油；他写信感叹命运讽刺，却未遵医嘱。他于1896年死于脑出血。
- 揭谜 后来查明它释放一氧化氮、扩张血管；三位相关研究者获1998年生理学或医学诺奖，颁奖致辞在诺贝尔忌日引用了这封信。

参考答案　1 instability 2 tolerance 3 comply 4 ascertained